

CHAPTER 2

Preliminary Notes



This chapter is part of the PINK and GOLD reading tours. See Figure 1-1 in Chapter 1, Section 1.3, for alternative reading tours.

To fully understand and appreciate the TOGAF Standard, some background information is necessary. It is essential to know the origins of the world's leading architecture framework as this helps to form a complete picture of the evolution that the TOGAF Standard has gone through and the moments in time that determined the growth of the framework.

The emergence of architecture frameworks has been the catalyst for the creation and evolution of the TOGAF Standard as we know it today.

This chapter discusses the development of the TOGAF Standard and its subsequent evolution in detail.

2.1. A Brief History

Enterprise Architecture emerged in the 1960s and 1970s as large organizations began to see the need for more formal methods of managing their complex (IT) systems and aligning them with business goals and intended outcomes. At that time, several attempts were made to develop system architectures and information models.

In the 1980s, the term Enterprise Architecture began to take hold. At that time, the focus was on defining and documenting the structure and components of an organization's information systems. The primary focus lay at the intersection of IT and information delivery. During this decade, methodologies such as John Zachman's Framework for Enterprise Architecture emerged. Enterprise Architecture has evolved in response to the increasing complexity of IT environments and related business processes.

The Zachman Framework (actually an *ontology*) was published by John Zachman in 1987 [4]. It was the first framework to focus on structuring IT infrastructure and business processes.

During the 1990s, the Zachman Framework became increasingly popular as an Enterprise Architecture methodology. The framework was used by many organizations, including government agencies and other large corporations. The framework underwent several revisions to better meet the changing needs of organizations.

The 1990s marked a period of increasing interest and growth in the field of Enterprise Architecture. More and more organizations recognized the importance of aligning IT with their business goals. In 1995, The Open Group introduced what is now called the TOGAF Standard, which provided a comprehensive approach to Enterprise Architecture.

In the early 2000s, more emphasis was placed on the integration of IT and business strategies, leading to the adoption of Enterprise Architecture as a strategic management discipline. Enterprise Architecture frameworks and methodologies, such as the Zachman Framework and the TOGAF Standard, became more widely accepted and used. In the mid- to late 2000s, Enterprise Architecture evolved to address the complexity of globalized and networked organizations. The focus shifted to a more holistic approach to Enterprise Architecture that included not only IT systems, but also business processes, people, and organizational structures. This broader perspective was necessary to adapt to rapidly changing market dynamics and technological innovations.

The evolution of Enterprise Architecture brought a new level of focus to the strategic importance of IT within organizations. It became a way to align IT infrastructure and business processes with business goals, thereby increasing the value of IT. Enterprise Architecture also offered a way to manage and reduce the complexity of IT environments, thereby reducing the cost and risk of IT projects.

The evolution of today's leading architectural frameworks, starting with the introduction of the Zachman Framework, is shown in Figure 2-1.

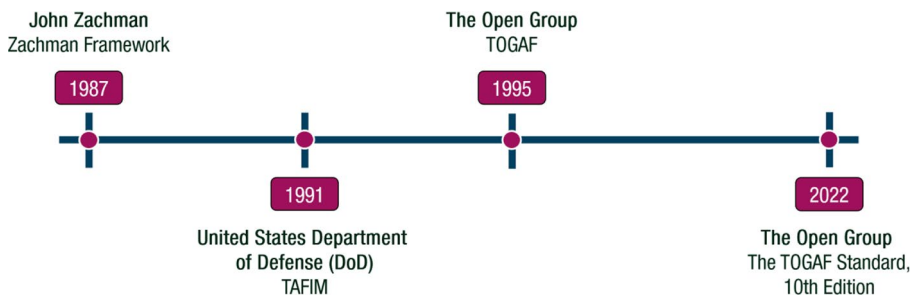


Figure 2-1. *The evolution of today's leading architecture frameworks*

Shortly after 2000, the Zachman Framework was further developed, extended, and adapted to the changing needs of organizations. More attention was given to the relationship between Enterprise Architecture and digital transformation, and new tools and techniques were developed to support Enterprise Architecture modeling. Of course, the Zachman Framework has also been criticized, and the applicability and practical value of the framework and its role in an ever-changing IT environment have been debated.

Throughout the 2010s, Enterprise Architecture became increasingly aligned with other strategic management disciplines, such as business process management, data management, and enterprise security. Enterprise Architecture evolved into an essential tool for guiding digital transformation initiatives, cloud adoption, and agile development practices.